



Leveraging Locally Led AA and Strengthening Maintenance and Readiness

Lessons Learned from WAHAFA End Evaluation





WAHAFA EVALUATION REPORT 2023-2025



Locals in the lead

Locally Led AA: WAHAFA's Core Strength
WAHAFA empowers local actors and communities to shape anticipatory action in ways that fit their realities making them **active drivers of change**.

Growing Demand and Interest for Anticipatory Action

- Organisations & governments **recognise AA**; **Communities** themselves are calling for more **involvement**.
- In Zimbabwe, locally led tools like **P-FIM** show how **meaningful participation** helps communities organise, act on forecasts, and define **what matters**.

WAHAFA Accelerates Locally Led Anticipatory Action

- Supports partners to **embed AA into own systems & frameworks**.
- Works closely with **local authorities, NGOs & communities**.
- Builds momentum for sustainable, locally led approaches.

Emerging Structures and Momentum

- New AA working groups in **Somaliland, Zimbabwe, and Germany**.
- WHH's internal **Anticipation & Preparedness Fund** established.
- **Stronger foundations for long-term, locally led AA** are now in place



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Operational Readiness Matters

Maintaining operational readiness is **essential to ensure AAPs remain effective and actionable over time**. It does not automatically persist after AAPs are validated.

Practical ways to address this:

- **Flexible low scale funding for readiness maintenance**, to allow light-touch activities such as refreshers, simulations, and targeted updates when risks to readiness are identified.
- **Periodic refresher and simulation exercises**, to test roles, decision-making, and activation steps, especially after long periods without activation or staff turnover.

- **Maintaining access and logistical arrangements**, including renewing framework agreements and checking supplier and market feasibility over time.
- **Proportional community engagement**, to keep communication channels active and manage expectations when AAPs remain inactive.



AAP ACTIVATION DROUGHT

ZIMBABWE 2024



Trigger:

WFP drought model alert in July:

high probability of **below-normal average rainfall** for October – December 2024 indicating incoming drought

→ confirmed by Zimbabwe's Meteorological Services Department and at-risk communities

CASE STUDY ZIMBABWE DROUGHT



TRIGGER
JULY 2024



fuel FUNDS
€ 150,000

PEOPLE SUPPORTED

9,947
(plus 13,000 cattle & 2,000 goats)



AAP ACTIVATION DROUGHT

ZIMBABWE 2024



**Deworming and dipping of
13,000 cattle**



**Supplementary feeding of
livestock for 5,500 cattle**



**Piped Water Scheme construction
and troughs for 14,000 cattle**



AAP ACTIVATION DROUGHT

ZIMBABWE 2024



Zero livestock losses across two drought periods ('24/'25)



Millions of euros in assets safeguarded



Income losses avoided



€2.53 per cattle

Impact

- **€150,000 investment** supported ~10,000 people and protected ~14,000 cattle

Economic value

- Healthy cow value: €350–510 (vs. €70–85 in distress sales)
- Assets worth millions of euros protected (No livestock losses recorded in the project areas)

Without Anticipatory Action

- Neighboring communities **without** anticipatory action support: **~30% livestock losses**
- Higher humanitarian needs
- More costly, reactive interventions required



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Evidence Creation Challenges and Needs

1. Timing

Challenge: Interventions occur before shocks - limited baseline data and unclear comparison points

Need: Rapid, pre-trigger data collection systems and secondary data

2. Data Availability

Challenge: Sparse, low-quality, or non-comparable data in remote or crisis-prone areas

Need: Investment in simple, standardized data systems and local data collection capacity

3. Operational Constraints

Challenge: Limited staff time, funding, and access; competing priorities during crises

Need: Lean evaluation approaches, integration with program delivery, and dedicated resources for M&E



Key Action identified: Collaborate with research institutions to generate more robust and credible impact evidence



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THANK YOU

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